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Board of Education Report

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File #: Rep-085-23/24, **Version:** 1

Approval of the Early Literacy School Block Grant (ELSBG) Literacy Action Plan Annual Updates October 17, 2023 Division of Instruction

Action Proposed:

Ratification of the Annual Updates of the Literacy Action Plans for the six Los Angeles Unified schools participating in the Early Literacy School Block Grant (ELSBG). The California Department of Education (CDE) requires Board ratification to release Year Three school funding. The total Grant Award is **\$4,777,355** and continues through June 30, 2024.

Background:

In 2017, the *Ella T. v. the State of California* lawsuit was filed on behalf of current and former students and teachers at three low-performing schools: La Salle Avenue Elementary School in Los Angeles Unified School District, Van Buren Elementary School in the Stockton Unified School District, and Children of Promise Preparatory Academy, a charter school in the Inglewood Unified School District. The suit alleged that the State violated students' civil rights by denying them a quality education and, specifically, a fundamental right to literacy. The case argued that state education officials knew of a "crisis" of reading and writing in California public schools yet failed to develop a comprehensive plan or provide the funding necessary for early literacy.

On February 20, 2020, a settlement agreement was reached between the parties. State education officials have agreed to develop and implement the Early Literacy School Block Grant (ELSBG) as part of the agreement. The ELSBG was authorized by Senate Bill 98, Sections 113 and 114 (Statutes of 2020) of the Education Omnibus Trailer Bill.

Block Grant Amount

The State has agreed to allocate \$50 million over three years to eligible schools and no more than \$3 million in administrative costs for the California Department of Education (CDE) to administer grants, review and approve plans.

Grant Eligibility

The list of eligible schools consists of 75 schools, including charter schools. These schools had the highest percentage in the State of students scoring Level 1 on the grade 3 English Language Arts (ELA) Smarter Balanced Assessment (SBA), based on a two-year weighted average of the 2018 and 2019 ELA SBA results.

School	Award Amount	BD	Region	Community of School
La Salle ES	\$563,140 (Annually: \$187,713)	1	West	HEET (C/D)

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School	Award Amount	BD	Region	Community of School
42nd ES	\$338,823 (Annually: 112,941)	1	West	HEET (W)
YES Academy	\$943,848 (Annually: \$314,616)	1	West	HEET (W)
West Athens ES	\$943,848 (Annually: \$314,616)	1	West	HEET (W)
28th Street ES	\$943,848 (Annually: \$314,616)	2	East	Jefferson/South Central
Fries ES	\$943,848 (Annually: \$314,616)	7	South	Wilmington

The total Los Angeles Unified Grant Award is \$4,777,355.

Program Overview

The ELSB Grant is authorized for four years to provide funding to support early literacy development at identified schools through June 30, 2024. During the 2020-2021 planning year, each school completed a Root Cause Analysis, conducted a Needs Assessment, and wrote a Literacy Action Plan (LAP) that addresses the needs identified in the Root Cause Analysis and Needs Assessment.

The CDE has authorized the Sacramento County Office of Education (SCOE) to be the expert lead in literacy for the State and provide professional development and support for the ELSB Grant implementation. SCOE has partnered with Consortium on Reaching Excellence in Education (CORE) and Pivot to provide professional development and support for grant recipients. SCOE provides bimonthly professional development to support the implementation of the Root Cause Analysis and Needs Assessment, and the writing of the Literacy Action Plan. Strategies included in the LAP(s) should be evidence- and research-based.

SCOE, CDE, and the Los Angeles Unified Board of Education must approve Literacy Action Plans and the annual updates. Grant funds only fund supplemental activities targeted for Kindergarten through Grade 3 inclusive and shall not supplant existing activities. There are four categories of grant expenditures allowed:

- Category 1: Access to High-Quality Literacy Teaching
- Category 2: Support for Literacy Learning
- Category 3: Pupil Supports
- Category 4: Family and Community Supports

Expected Outcomes:

Approval of the annual update of the Literacy Action Plans for the six participating schools will ensure the continued implementation of early literacy strategies in 2023-2024. As a result, reading proficiency, as measured by Dynamic Indicators of Early Literacy Skills (DIBELS) and other indicators, will continue to increase for kindergarten through third grade students at each school.

Board Options and Consequences:

If the Board ratifies the grant, ELSBG schools will have access to grant funds for the purpose of implementing their Literacy Action Plans.

A “No” vote would deny schools access to allocated funds necessary for the implementation of their three-year Literacy Action Plans.

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Policy Implications:

This ELSB Grant supports the Board resolutions, Creating a Birth to Eight Roadmap for Success in Los Angeles and Realizing the Promise for All: Close the Gap by 2023. It also supports the Primary Promise initiative and the District's Local Control Accountability Plan (LCAP) early literacy goals.

Budget Impact:

Not Applicable

Student Impact:

Approval of the grant will support increased attendance, academic achievement and services for students at participating ELSBG schools.

Equity Impact:

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Recognition	4	All 6 participating schools (28 th Street ES, 42 nd Street ES, Fries ES, La Salle ES, West Athens ES and YES Academy ES) are in historically underserved communities with high percentages of traditionally underserved student groups such as Emergent Bilinguals, Standard English Learners, African American students, Foster Youth, and Students with Disabilities.
Resource Prioritization	4	Schools will use ELSBG funds to teach systematic, explicit foundational skills instruction in both whole group and small group settings using data to target the specific needs of students who represent student groups such as Emergent Bilinguals, Standard English Learners, African American students, Foster Youth, and Students with Disabilities.
Results	4	Implementation of literacy action plan strategies will increase DIBELS benchmark and progress monitoring data at participating schools.
TOTAL	12	

Issues and Analysis:

None

Attachments:

Attachment A - Summary of ELSBG Schools Literacy Action Plan Annual Updates

Informatives:

Not Applicable.

Submitted:

09/19/23

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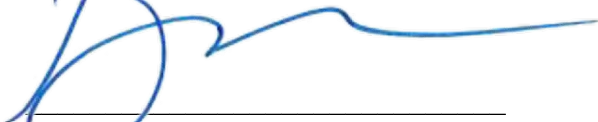
RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


ALBERTO M. CARVALHO
Superintendent

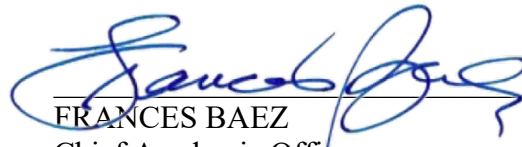
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Division of Instruction

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REVIEWED BY:


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☒ Approved as to budget impact statement.

Summary of ELSBG Schools Literacy Action Plan Annual Updates

28th Street Elementary Literacy Goals and Action Plan Overview

- Goal 1: Provide consistent and explicit instruction in foundational skills (K-3).
- Goal 2: Provide consistent oral language development and explicit vocabulary instruction for our EL and EO students.
- Goal 3: Provide explicit and systematic instruction in phonics, phonemic awareness, fluency, vocabulary, and comprehension.

Key Action Items	Rationale	Updates
Reading Horizons, Heggerty and 95% materials will be purchased for K-3 teachers who will be provided connected professional development on explicit teaching of phonics, phonemic awareness, fluency, comprehension and vocabulary. Hire a Literacy Coach to work with students in grades K-3 on foundational skills. Implement targeted, data driven small group instruction/intervention for K-3rd. Implement a structured ELD block for K-3 students. Title III coach will provide training on vocabulary instruction, oral language development strategies and activities.	Root cause analysis and needs assessment revealed: - Inconsistent delivery of instruction in foundational skills across grades K-3 - A need for a highly effective foundational skills curriculum - A need for professional development in literacy foundational skills	The actions the school site has taken toward goals: - Teachers participated in professional development: OERA, Orton-Gillingham, LETRS, Heggerty, Writer's Workshop. - Teachers participated in consistent and focused grade level planning and data analysis. - Title III coach provided demo lessons, coaching and data chats. Year 3 Actions: - Hire instructional coach to support Tier 1 instruction - Transition to "leveled academy" model - Hire additional paraprofessionals to support classrooms - Lead teachers provide model classrooms for observation by other teachers

2022-2023 DIBELS DATA (Data Source: PowerBI)

Grade Level	BOY				EOY			
	Well Below Benchmark	Below Benchmark	Benchmark	Above Benchmark	Well Below Benchmark	Below Benchmark	Benchmark	Above Benchmark
Kindergarten	44%	25%	16%	16%	20%	7%	31%	42%
1 st Grade	39%	12%	25%	24%	12%	14%	29%	45%
2 nd Grade	47%	18%	21%	15%	29%	18%	27%	26%
3 rd Grade	49%	22%	17%	13%	41%	10%	18%	31%

Kindergarten showed a 41% increase in students scoring Benchmark and Above Benchmark from beginning of year (BOY) to end of year (EOY). There was a 22% decrease in the number of Kindergarten students scoring Well Below Benchmark from BOY to EOY.

42nd Street Elementary Literacy Goals and Action Plan Overview

- Goal 1: Build Teachers' capacity in the quality of instructional delivery.
- Goal 2: Provide explicit, systematic foundational reading skills instruction.

Key Action Items	Rationale	Updates
Ongoing professional development to analyze the literacy data and develop/implement strategies to address student needs will be provided by the on-site READ Expert.	Needs assessment and data analysis reveal: - A majority of K-3 students are testing below proficiency in phonemic awareness and phonics - A need to provide more targeted instructional in differentiated small groups - A need for strategic use of instructional aides to support teachers during differentiated instruction	The actions the school site has taken toward goals: - Students receive daily small group instruction. - Teachers engaged in ongoing professional development on Heggerty and SIPPS. - Ongoing data analysis meetings were held with teachers. Year 3 Actions: - Focus on comprehension and fluency - Hire educational aides to support instruction during class time
Ongoing training will be provided for instructional aides to facilitate ELA skills practice.		
Ongoing professional development will be provided for teachers to improve phonics and literacy instruction.		
Implement consistent small group instruction 4-5 days per week in grades TK/K-3 with 6-week data cycles to analyze DIBELS benchmark and progress monitoring data to inform adjustments to instruction.		

2022-2023 DIBELS DATA (Data Source: PowerBI)

Grade Level	BOY				EOY		
	Well Below Benchmark	Below Benchmark	Benchmark	Above Benchmark	Well Below Benchmark	Below Benchmark	Above Benchmark
Kindergarten	39%	17%	28%	17%	53%	12%	18%
1 st Grade	38%	23%	38%	0	42%	0	25%
2 nd Grade	74%	4%	19%	4%	39%	17%	19%
3 rd Grade	58%	26%	5%	11%	37%	32%	21%

Second grade showed a 12% increase in students scoring Benchmark and Above Benchmark from beginning of year (BOY) to end of year (EOY). There was a 35% decrease in the number of second grade students scoring Well Below Benchmark from BOY to EOY.

Fries Street Elementary Literacy Goals and Action Plan Overview

- Goal 1: Provide explicit, systematic phonemic awareness instruction.
- Goal 2: Provide explicit, systematic phonics instruction.
- Goal 3: Provide explicit, systematic vocabulary instruction.
- Goal 4: Provide explicit, systematic reading comprehension instruction.

Key Action Items	Rationale	Updates
Hire an Intervention Teacher to work with students in grades TK–3, focusing specifically on early foundational literacy skills.	Needs assessment and data analysis reveal: - A majority of TK–3 students are testing below proficiency in phonemic awareness, phonics and comprehension according to screening data - A need to build the capacity of TK-3 teachers to provide systematic, explicit instruction - A need for teacher assistants to be trained in early literacy along with and by the teachers to support small group instruction - A need to engage and empower parents to support literacy development at home	The actions the school site has taken toward goals: - ABC Consulting provided monthly coaching, lesson study, and professional development. - Teachers engaged in professional development on early literacy skills and the science of reading. Year 3 Actions: - Teachers engage in professional development to support tier 1 instruction - Select teachers engage in LETRS training
Contract with a literacy consultant to provide professional development and demo lessons for TK–3rd grade teachers and teacher assistants on providing targeted foundational literacy skills, and on teaching vocabulary and comprehension skills through shared reading, read alouds, and guided reading.		
Offer school-wide, integrated family events with each event focusing on literacy. These events will be held throughout the year to provide the needed support for parents to address the literacy needs of their child.		

2022-2023 DIBELS DATA (Data Source: PowerBI)

Grade Level	BOY				EOY			
	Well Below Benchmark	Below Benchmark	Benchmark	Above Benchmark	Well Below Benchmark	Below Benchmark	Benchmark	Above Benchmark
Kindergarten	60%	19%	11%	11%	41%	22%	20%	17%
1 st Grade	32%	20%	41%	7%	16%	19%	30%	35%
2 nd Grade	52%	16%	23%	9%	30%	16%	32%	23%
3 rd Grade	51%	15%	24%	10%	43%	7%	27%	23%

First grade showed a 18% increase in students scoring Benchmark and Above Benchmark from beginning of year (BOY) to end of year (EOY) DIBELS administration . There was a 16% decrease in the number of first grade students scoring Well Below Benchmark from BOY to EOY.

West Athens Elementary Literacy Goals and Action Plan Overview

- Goal 1: Provide Teacher training in assessing and progress monitoring students.
 Goal 2: Provide explicit phonemic awareness and phonics instruction.

Key Action Items	Rationale	Updates
Purchase the Consortium on Reaching Excellence in Education (CORE) Online Elementary Reading Academy (OERA) to provide initial and ongoing training for teachers.	Needs assessment and data analysis reveal: - A majority of K–3 students are testing below proficiency in phonemic awareness and phonics - A need for targeted instructional groupings of students so they can be placed in differentiated groups based on ongoing formative assessment data. - A need for professional learning, and administrative monitoring of the implementation of the new curriculum	The actions the school site has taken toward goals: - Teachers engaged in ongoing professional development on phonemic awareness, progress monitoring, and small group instruction. - Teachers participated in consistent and focused grade level planning and data analysis. - Teachers implemented SIPPS for foundational literacy skills. Year 3 Actions: - Expand literacy small group instruction to more students - Implement family workshops - Implement cycles of improvement
Purchase Heggerty, 95 Percent, LETRS and SIPPS Assessments to support consistent foundational skills instruction in whole group and small group settings.		
Hire four paraprofessionals to work with students in K-3 specifically on foundational reading skills.		
Conduct data cycles using ongoing progress monitoring and assessments with CORE assessments and DIBELS.		
The READ Expert will be utilized to coach and support teachers. The READ Expert will plan and facilitate lesson study in phonemic awareness, phonics, and progress monitoring to support literacy instruction.		

2022-2023 DIBELS DATA (Data Source: PowerBI)

Grade Level	BOY				EOY			
	Well Below Benchmark	Below Benchmark	Benchmark	Above Benchmark	Well Below Benchmark	Below Benchmark	Benchmark	Above Benchmark
Kindergarten	55%	18%	16%	11%	39%	17%	27%	17%
1 st Grade	56%	15%	18%	11%	41%	11%	22%	27%
2 nd Grade	58%	13%	16%	13%	44%	16%	15%	25%
3 rd Grade	47%	17%	21%	16%	45%	15%	9%	31%

Second Grade showed a 11% increase in students scoring Benchmark and Above Benchmark from beginning of year (BOY) to end of year (EOY).
 There was a 14% decrease in the number of second grade students scoring Well Below Benchmark from BOY to EOY.

YES Academy Literacy Goals and Action Plan Overview

- Goal 1: Provide explicit foundational skills instruction.
- Goal 2: Implement effective literacy small group instruction.
- Goal 3: Build teacher capacity in reading instruction.
- Goal 4: Engage families in the instructional program.

Key Action Items	Rationale	Updates
Hire an intervention teacher and teacher assistant to work with students in grades TK/K-3 students focusing on foundational reading skills.	Needs assessment and data analysis reveal: - A majority of TK/K-3 students are testing below proficiency in phonemic awareness and phonics according to BOY data - A need to build teacher capacity to deliver targeted and systematic in foundational skills instruction - A need for more effective small group instruction using data for grouping, regrouping and adjusting instruction	The actions the school site has taken toward goals: - Teachers engaged in ongoing professional development including LETRS and small group instruction. - Teachers participated in consistent and focused grade level planning and data analysis. - Parents and families attended workshops intended to promote early literacy skills at home.
Purchase Heggerty Curriculum and provide initial and ongoing training on the curriculum throughout the implementation year.		
Develop a monitoring plan to include data collection to assess the implementation of the professional learning plan as well as cycles of improvement.		Year 3 Actions: - Teachers to engage in professional development on foundational literacy skills - Hire two instructional aides to support small group instruction
Provide effective differentiated small group instruction based on DIBELS and supplemental diagnostic data, such as CORE Phonics Survey and PAST Assessments.		
Provide ongoing professional development for teachers to support coherent, explicit, and systemic delivery of phonemic awareness lessons.		

2022-2023 DIBELS DATA (Data Source: PowerBI)

Grade Level	BOY				EOY			
	Well Below Benchmark	Below Benchmark	Benchmark	Above Benchmark	Well Below Benchmark	Below Benchmark	Benchmark	Above Benchmark
Kindergarten	47%	27%	11%	16%	39%	17%	27%	17%
1 st Grade	51%	24%	17%	8%	55%	6%	12%	26%
2 nd Grade	65%	11%	17%	8%	62%	9%	11%	18%
3 rd Grade	67%	12%	15%	7%	65%	6%	15%	14%

Kindergarten showed a 17% increase in students scoring Benchmark and Above Benchmark from beginning of year (BOY) to end of year (EOY). There was a 7% decrease in the number of Kindergarten students scoring Well Below Benchmark from BOY to EOY.